



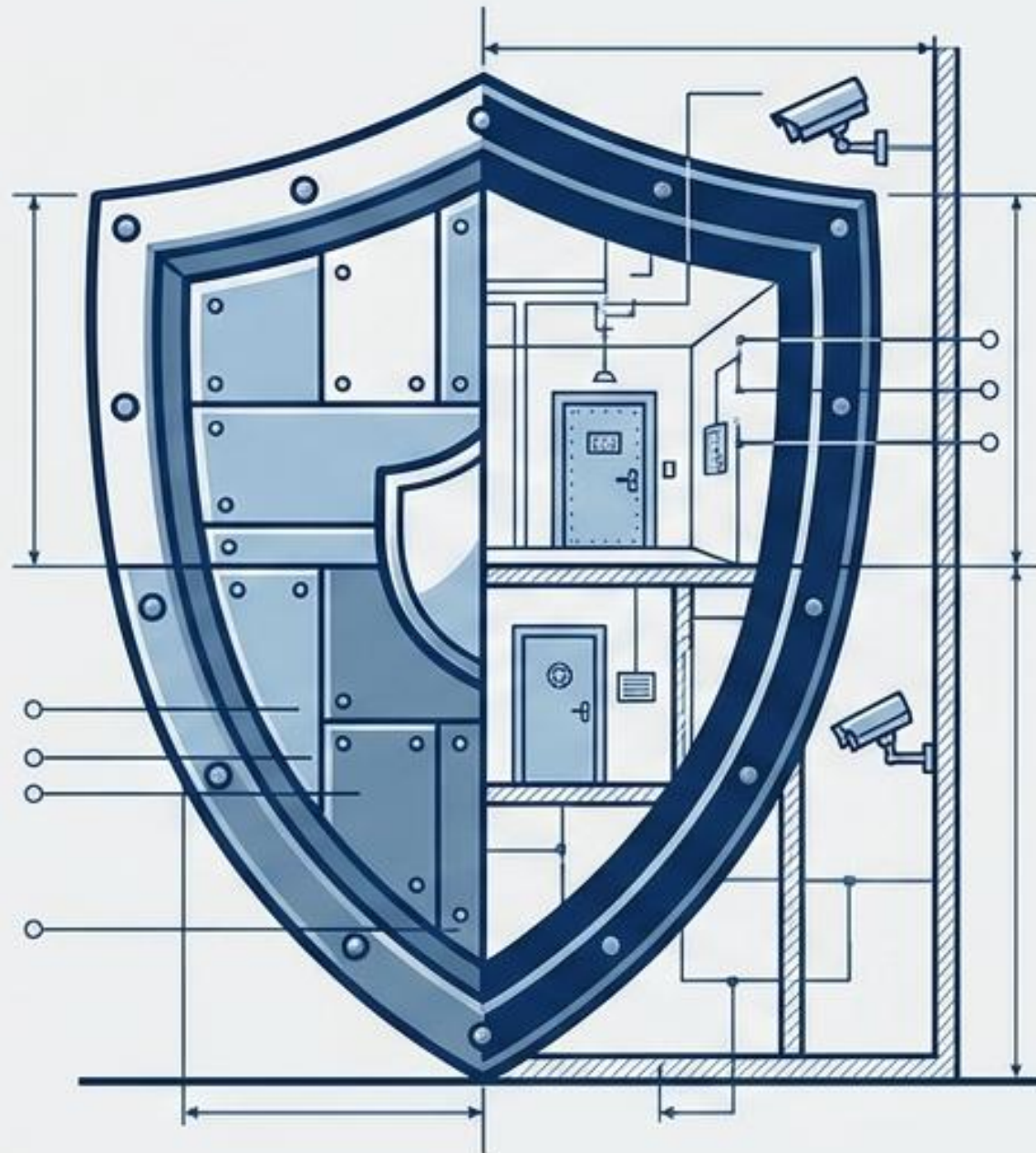
BLUETEAMERS

A Day in the Life of a SOC Analyst

Presented by Blueteamers



The First Line of Defence



1

Workflow Over Tools

Before learning tools and techniques, understand what the job actually looks like.

2

The Primary Mission

A Tier 1 SOC Analyst serves as the very first line of defence in cybersecurity.

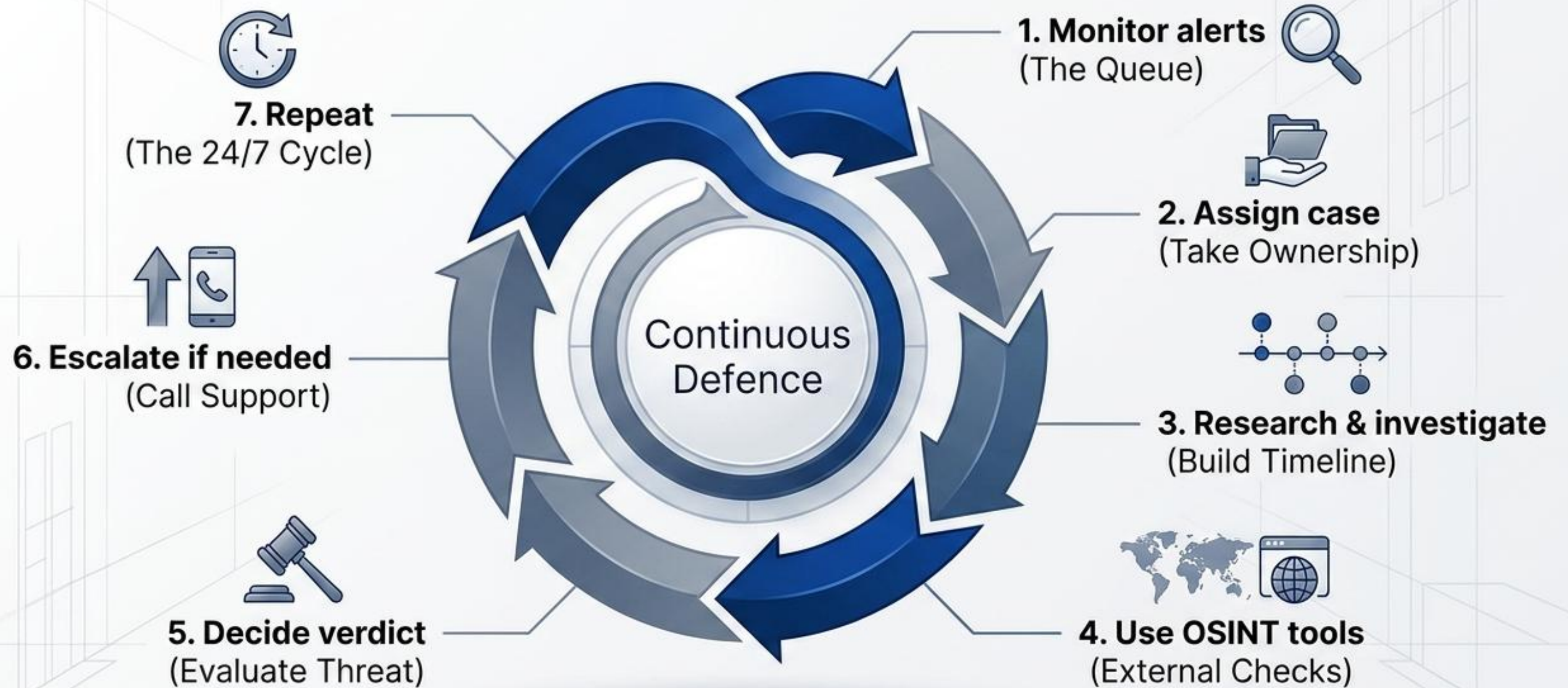
3

The Dual Mindset

To succeed, you must combine the technical precision of a systems engineer with the investigative instincts of a detective.



The Continuous SOC Workflow





Phase 1: Monitoring the Queue

The Technical Reality



Your day begins by monitoring an alert queue for incoming security warnings. When an alert triggers, you must **immediately** assign the case to yourself to prevent duplicated work across the team.

The Real-World Analogy

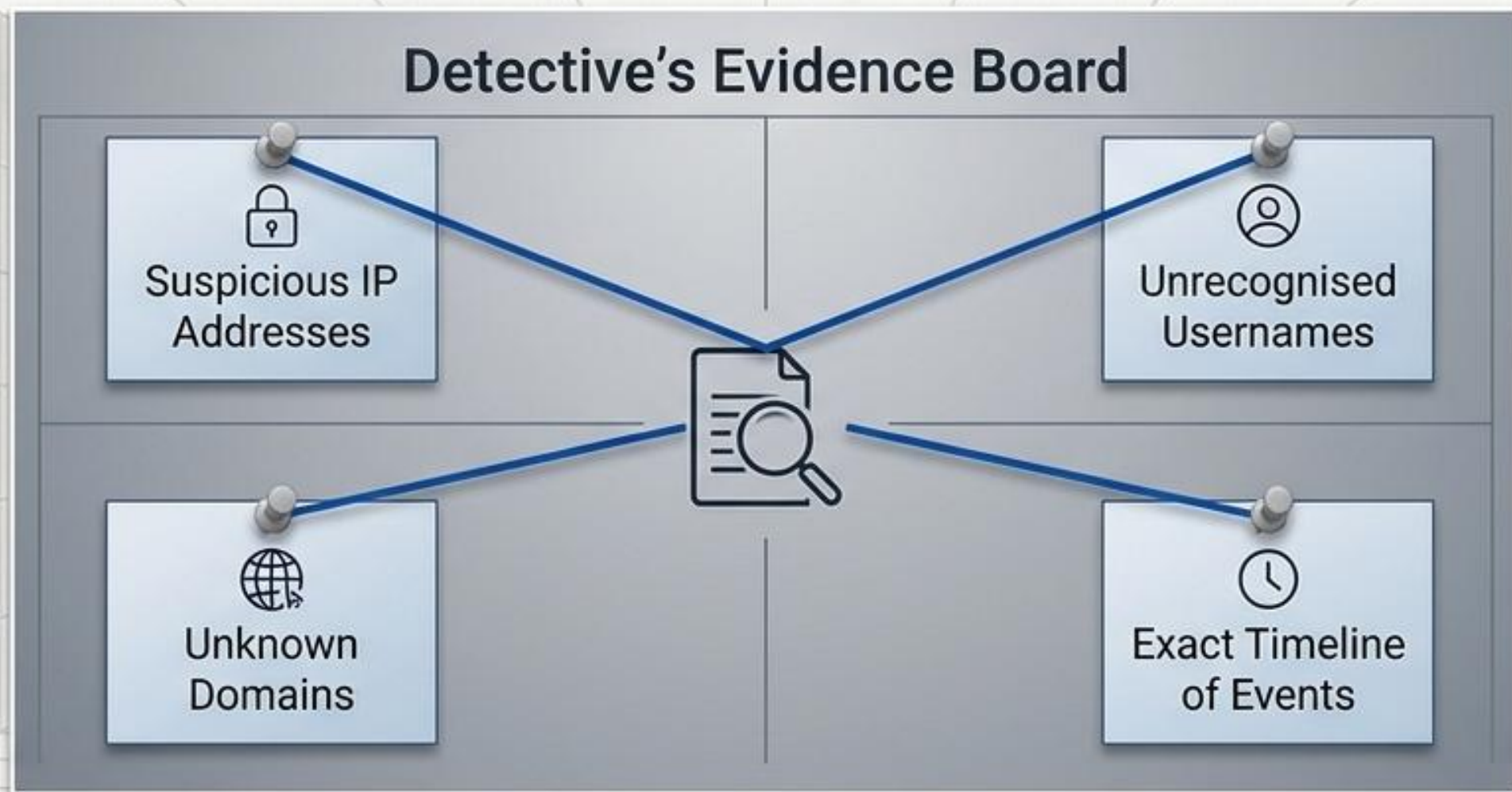


You are a 911 dispatcher or a front-desk security guard. A motion sensor light flashes on the 3rd floor. You pick up the radio and say, "I'm on it," taking total ownership of the investigation.



Phase 2: Playing Detective

Research the timeline of events and hunt for **Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)**.



You are looking for the exact moment the perimeter was breached and building a chronological story of the attacker's movements.



The Toolkit Translator

SIEM

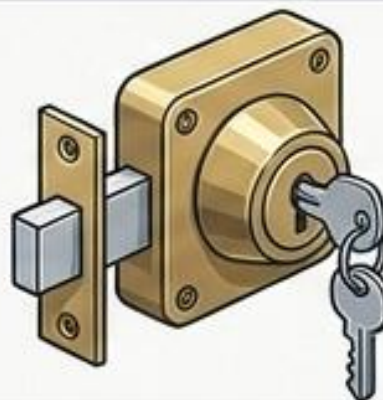
Splunk, Sentinel, QRadar



Security Camera System: Allows you to rewind the tape and build a timeline of who entered the network and when.

EDR

CrowdStrike, Microsoft Defender



Locks on the Doors: Allows you to check the endpoints to see if they were picked, forced open, or bypassed.

OSINT

VirusTotal, AbuseIPDB



Police Database: Allows you to run a suspect's IP address through external systems to check for a known criminal record.

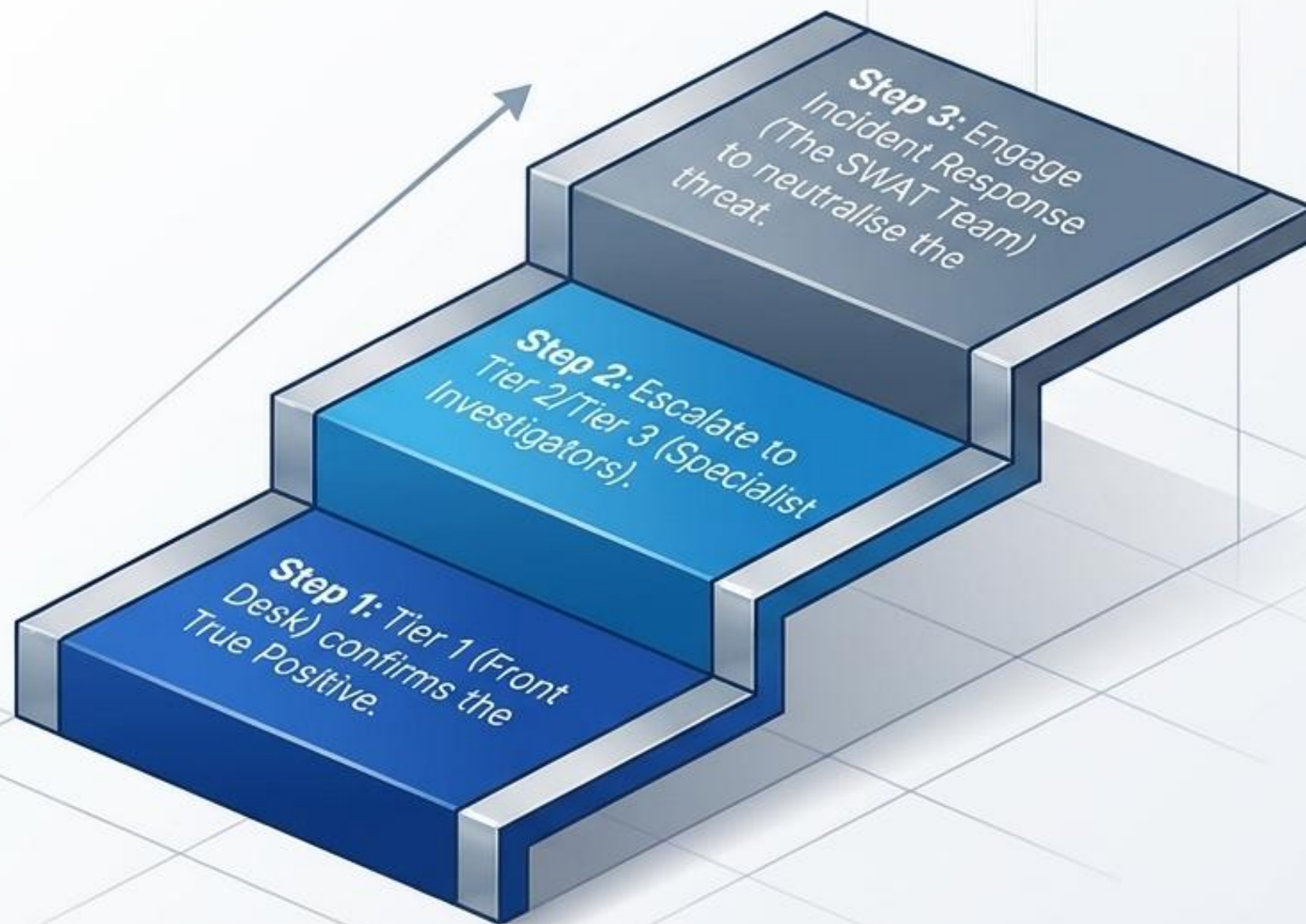
Phase 3: The Verdict Matrix



	False Positive	True Positive	
Threat Level	Not a real threat. 	Threat Level	Real, active attack. 
Example	Scheduled PowerShell task running a routine update. 	Example	Login from a foreign IP address + multiple failed password attempts. 
Analogy	Motion alarm triggered by the office cat or scheduled cleaner. 	Analogy	Security cameras show an unauthorised person actively trying to pry open a safe. 
Required Action	Document findings and close the ticket. 	Required Action	Escalate immediately. 



Phase 4: Escalation & Documentation



The form is titled "INCIDENT REPORT" and features two police badges at the top. It contains several sections with labels and input fields:

- Incident Information:** Includes fields for "Date/Time", "Location", "Officer", and "Subject".
- Incident Details:** Includes checkboxes for "Solved", "Unresolved", "Escalated", and "Reopened".
- Investigation Summary:** A table with columns for "Date/Time", "Location", "Officer", and "Subject".
- Officer's Signature:** A line for a signature and a circular stamp.
- Supervisor's Signature:** A line for a signature and a circular stamp.

Write the Police Report

Regardless of a true or false positive, you must write a detailed report so the next shift knows exactly what happened and how the alert was handled.

The Reality of the Shift



1 24/7 Monitoring Environment



The perimeter never sleeps, and neither does the SOC.

2 Shift Work



Night shifts and irregular hours are a normal part of the job.

3 Fast-Paced Decisions



You must balance thorough investigation with the need for rapid triage.

4 High Responsibility



You are the gatekeeper deciding whether an alert is a harmless glitch or a company-ending breach.



Actionable Advice for Beginners

Embrace the Alerts



Don't fear the queue. Investigate thoroughly and follow the data wherever it leads.

Leverage the Team



Ask senior analysts questions. The SOC is a collaborative environment, not a solo mission.

Get Hands-On



Practice your investigative skills in simulated lab environments before you hit the live floor.

Recommended Labs: TryHackMe & Blue Team Labs.
Document everything you learn.

The Mindset over the Machine



**The workflow is your compass;
the tools are just your vehicle.**

Tools will change, software will update, and interfaces will evolve. But the fundamental workflow—monitor, investigate, verify, and escalate—remains the universal language of defence.



Follow Blueteamers for real-world Blue Team insights.